

Aaron I. Pollock

Backend & Support Engineering • APIs, Observability, Production Debugging

Culver City, CA • aaronipollock@gmail.com • (323) 251-4892

[linkedin.com/in/aaronipollock](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aaronipollock) • github.com/aaronipollock • aaronipollock.github.io

Summary

Customer-centric engineer with hands-on backend experience shipping production AI integrations and debugging API-driven systems. I partner with engineering teams on root cause analysis, integration issues, and production debugging, with thirteen years of experience explaining technical concepts to learners and stakeholders at every skill level.

Technical Skills

API & Integration Work: REST APIs, GraphQL, root cause analysis • **Languages:** JavaScript, Python, SQL • **Backend:** Node.js, Express, Django REST Framework • **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL • **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS (S3, EC2, IAM, CloudWatch, Cloud Practitioner certified), Docker • **AI/LLM:** Anthropic Claude API, Stability AI, structured output validation, prompt engineering, fallback pipelines • **Observability:** Sentry, Pino, request tracing • **Tools:** Git/GitHub, Jira, Postman • **Frontend:** React, React Native

Experience

Better Angels LA — Volunteer Engineering Team Member Los Angeles, CA | Oct 2024 – Present

- Reproduced an intermittent UI bug engineers couldn't replicate, documenting trigger conditions and investigation steps for future debugging
- Implemented backend features and resolved integration issues across REST and GraphQL surfaces, partnering with engineers to scope solutions and ship documented changes
- Shipped 20+ merged PRs across a Django + GraphQL monorepo spanning backend models, migrations, schema updates, and UI features

Selected Projects

Low-sAI (Live App) — Jan 2025 – Present | www.low-sai.com

Memory-training web app integrating Anthropic Claude and Stability AI APIs using Node.js, Express, MongoDB, and JWT auth

- Built a validated fallback pipeline that gracefully degrades on API errors, rate limits, and invalid LLM output, with type guards coercing Claude responses before they reach downstream services
- Integrated Anthropic Claude and Stability AI APIs to transform user input into structured image-generation workflows using few-shot prompting, schema validation, phonetic encoding rules, and downstream rendering
- Introduced structured logging (Pino) with request correlation and Sentry instrumentation for faster incident triage and request-level visibility

Note2be — July 2024 | capstone-project-xsl6.onrender.com

A note-taking app with hierarchical tagging and media attachments built with Python/Flask/PostgreSQL

- Designed normalized PostgreSQL schemas using SQLAlchemy ORM
- Added REST APIs supporting CRUD operations across relational models
- Resolved data consistency and API response issues across note, tag, and media workflows

Getsy — June 2024 | etsyclone-4ah1.onrender.com

An Etsy clone exploring e-commerce workflows: cart, checkout, S3 media uploads, payment flows. Group project; contributed to backend services and AWS S3 integration

- Configured AWS S3 for secure media uploads with controlled object access
- Debugged state and integration issues across cart, order, and media systems

Selected Engineering Investigations

- Debugging an Unreachable JWT Recovery Flow — Identified a server/client auth-status mismatch that prevented one expired-token recovery path from reaching refresh logic
- Diagnosing Latency and Timeout Behavior with Sentry — Used structured logging and tracing to isolate upstream latency and timeout behavior in a Node/Express API

Additional Experience

Elite Prep — Tutor & Curriculum Manager | Arcadia, CA | Jun 2010 – Aug 2023

- Served as primary point of contact for parents, students, and staff, managing competing priorities and adapting technical explanations across varying skill levels

Education

App Academy — Full-Stack Web Development

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

University of Southern California — Cinematic Writing, BFA (Philosophy minor)

Aug 2000 – May 2004